21 DAYS CHALLENGE

Focus Area:
Today’s focus is on how smiling can enhance your public speaking.

These are the 3 main reasons to smile while speaking:

1. A smile makes you look friendly, approachable, and composed. It’s infectious, making the audience reciprocate.
2. Smiling calms your nerves by decreasing stress hormones and increasing mood-enhancing hormones.
3. Smiling helps convey friendliness and creates a strong first impression.

Assignment:

Record a video using the script I am sharing, in your own words, but with a sweet smile.

Space for Dashrath Manjhi Script

Tip: Don’t overdo it to the point that it looks fake. Keep practicing, keep smiling!

The Story of Dashrath Manjhi

Dashrath Manjhi, also known as the "Mountain Man," was a poor laborer in a remote village in Bihar, India. In 1959, his wife fell ill and needed urgent medical attention. However, the nearest town with a doctor was 70 kilometers away, and the path was obstructed by a steep mountain. Tragically, she died before Dashrath could get her the medical help she needed. Devastated by his wife's death and determined that no one else should suffer the same fate, Dashrath decided to carve a path through the mountain. Armed with only a hammer and chisel, he began his monumental task.

For 22 years, from 1960 to 1982, Dashrath toiled relentlessly. People in his village thought he was mad, but he continued undeterred. Finally, after decades of hard work, he succeeded in creating a path 110 meters long, 9.1 meters wide, and 7.7 meters deep through the mountain.

His extraordinary effort reduced the distance between the Atri and Wazirganj blocks of Gaya town from 55 km to 15 km, making it much easier for villagers to access medical care, schools, and markets.

The lesson: Dashrath Manjhi's story teaches us that determination and perseverance can move mountains—literally. No matter how insurmountable a challenge may seem, consistent effort and unwavering commitment can lead to remarkable achievements.